

Our objective is clear: to ensure Tamil Nadu remains not only India's manufacturing leader today, but also its most future-ready manufacturing destination for decades to come.



How has Tamil Nadu built such strong manufacturing infrastructure, and what is the government's vision going forward?

Infrastructure has always been one of Tamil Nadu's greatest competitive advantages.

Our network of SIPCOT (State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu) industrial parks provides manufacturers with ready industrial land and plug-and-play infrastructure. Combined with an extensive highway and rail network, multiple ports, and international airports, companies can efficiently connect their factories to both domestic and global markets.

But the next phase of industrialisation demands a broader vision. Earlier, industrial development largely meant creating industrial estates. Going forward, it will mean building integrated industrial ecosystems where manufacturing, suppliers, logistics, research and development (R&D), skilling, housing and social infrastructure evolve together.

That is the direction in which we are moving through integrated industrial townships, industrial corridors, multimodal logistics infrastructure and advanced manufacturing parks.

We also want to invest much more in research and innovation infrastructure by strengthening partnerships among universities, research institutions and industry. Increasingly, manufacturing competitiveness will be determined not just by production capacity, but by a state's ability to innovate.

Ultimately, infrastructure is no longer just about roads, land or utilities. It is about creating an ecosystem that lowers costs, improves productivity, accelerates innovation and enables higher-value manufacturing and at the same time, provides a good quality of life to workers.



Tamil Nadu has a rich manufacturing history since the 1950s. How has the state adapted to the era of technology and AI?

Tamil Nadu's manufacturing story has always been one of continuous evolution.

We began with textiles, heavy engineering,



automobiles and public-sector manufacturing. Today, we are among India's leaders in electronics manufacturing, electric mobility, advanced automotive systems and several emerging technology sectors.

Manufacturing, however, cannot remain static. Technology is fundamentally transforming the factory floor. AI, automation, robotics and the Industrial Internet of Things are improving productivity, reducing waste and reshaping manufacturing processes across industries.

As these technologies become mainstream, our responsibility is not only to help industries become globally competitive, but also to ensure that technological progress translates into greater opportunities for our people. Technology should enhance human potential, not diminish it. The factory of the future will create demand not only for technicians and operators, but also for production engineers, robotics programmers, AI specialists, chip designers and data analysts.

That is why Tamil Nadu has been proactive in introducing dedicated policies for semiconductors, advanced electronics, electric mobility, aerospace and defence, while simultaneously investing in skilling and